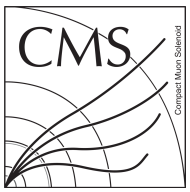
Internal review draft – 22 October 2026
No CMS DP number assigned



The Compact Muon Solenoid Experiment
CMS Performance Note



MCP-referenced timing calibration of CMS BTL prototype bars

CMS

cms-dpg-conveners-mtd@cern.ch

Abstract

A timing-calibration procedure is studied using CMS barrel timing layer (BTL) prototype scintillator bars in the September 2025 beam test. A microchannel-plate photomultiplier (MCP-PMT), digitized by an oscilloscope, provides an external arrival-time reference. A trigger link identifies coincident events in the BTL readout and the oscilloscope. Segment-dependent clock alignment and a locally weighted smoothing correction are used to map the reference into the BTL time coordinate.

The dependence of the measured arrival time on pulse charge is described by quadratic functions of inverse charge for four silicon-photomultiplier channels on two reference bars. These functions provide an empirical time-walk calibration over the measured charge range. Clock-corrected profiles provide the reference for the companion dual-threshold study; archived fits are retained to document the change in calibration procedure. Timing-difference distributions illustrate the validation strategy and the need to distinguish intrinsic reference-detector resolution from residual synchronization effects. This draft documents the available results and identifies the remaining selection, uncertainty and reproducibility checks before publication.

Draft v1 for scientific discussion. Not approved for public release.
The following slides retain explicitly marked review items.